Day 17 - River & Ruin, Squire Cleaver, River & Ruin, Dan Welsh

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Iroquoia section · hike 24 · River & Ruin Side Trail, Bronte Creek

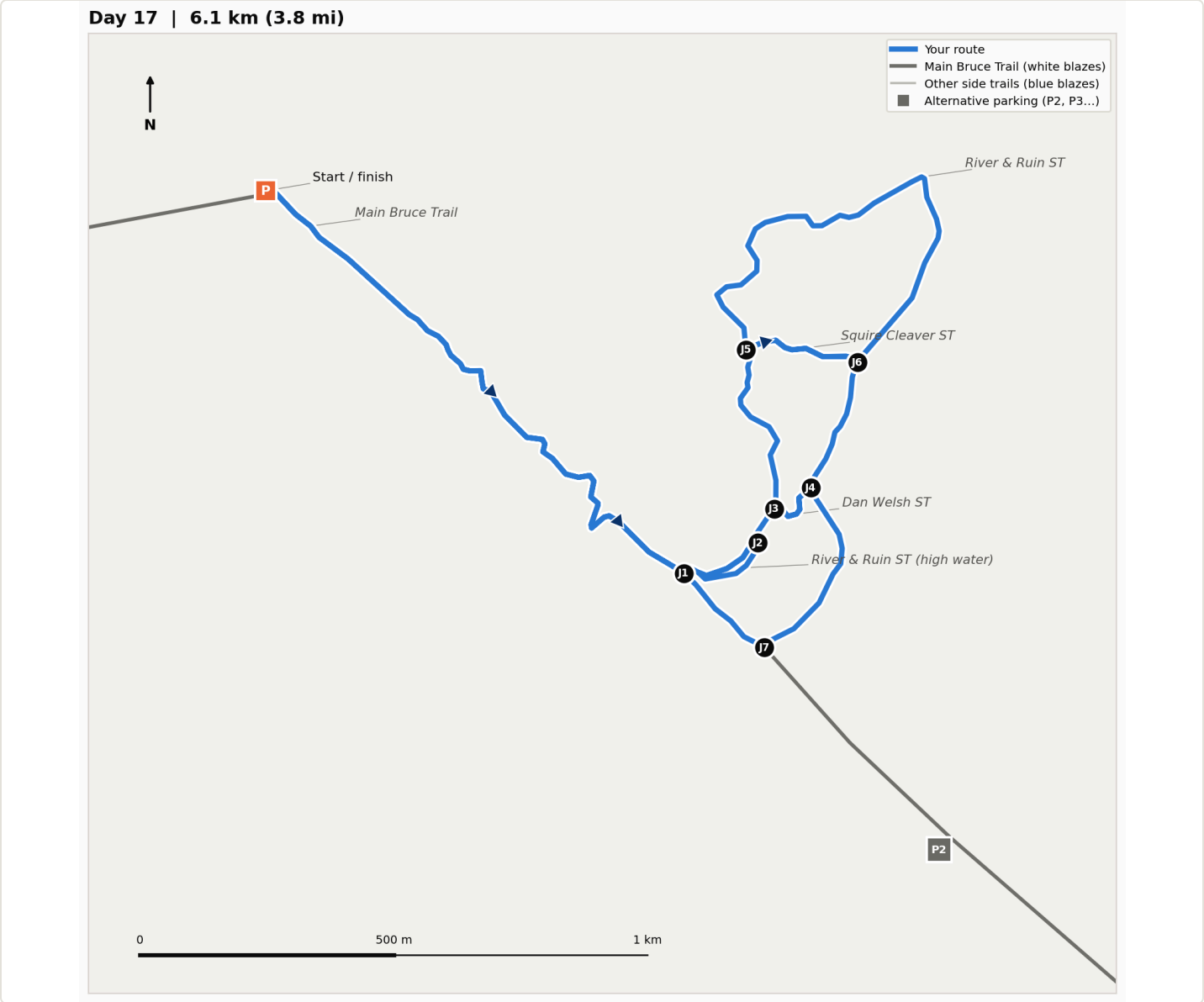
6.1 km / 3.8 mi	~1.9 h	2.9 km new	47 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside parking on Twiss Road at No 8 Sideroad. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day17_hike024.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: River & Ruin Side Trail (2.4 km); Squire Cleaver Side Trail (0.2 km); River & Ruin Side Trail (high water) (0.1 km); Dan Welsh Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on Twiss Rd at No 8 Sideroad.
- **River & Ruin Side Trail:** Passes through a spruce woodlot, past the ruins of an old stone house and alongside huge willow trees close to Bronte Creek.
- **High-water route:** The BTC decommissioned the side trail's low-water route in June 2026, so this route uses the high-water section only. Ignore any old low-water path or blazes you see near the creek.
- **Squire Cleaver and Dan Welsh side trails:** Short spurs (0.1-0.2 km); no descriptions were found.
- **Main Bruce Trail:** Only short connecting stretches; no specific details were found.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Official off road parking on north shoulder of Britannia Rd map	Free	4.7	540 m	

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 4.0 km / 2.5 mi, covering Dan Welsh, River & Ruin, River & Ruin (high water). **Outing 2** from P2 (Official off road parking on north shoulder of Britannia Rd; Free): 3.8 km / 2.3 mi, covering River & Ruin, Squire Cleaver. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking on Twiss Road at No 8 Sideroad. Head south-east on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail. The next 0.4 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
0.5	0.3	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
0.6	0.4	Heads-up: The next 0.4 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
1.0	0.6	Heads-up: The next 0.2 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
1.2	0.8	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed River & Ruin Side Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.) Then, continue straight onto the blue-blazed River & Ruin Side Trail (high water), heading east. (the blue-blazed River & Ruin Side Trail goes off ahead.)
1.4	0.9	J2: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
1.5	1.0	J1: Turn around onto the blue-blazed River & Ruin Side Trail, heading east. (the River & Ruin Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
1.7	1.1	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the River & Ruin Side Trail, heading north-east. (the River & Ruin Side Trail (high water) you already walked goes off behind you.)
1.8	1.1	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Dan Welsh Side Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed River & Ruin Side Trail goes off ahead.)
1.9	1.2	J4: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
2.0	1.3	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed River & Ruin Side Trail, heading north. (the River & Ruin Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
2.4	1.5	J5: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Squire Cleaver Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed River & Ruin Side Trail goes off ahead.)
2.6	1.6	J6: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
2.8	1.8	J5: Turn right onto the blue-blazed River & Ruin Side Trail, heading north. (the River & Ruin Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
4.0	2.5	J6: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the River & Ruin Side Trail, heading south. (the Squire Cleaver Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
4.2	2.6	J4: Junction. Turn left to stay on the River & Ruin Side Trail, heading south-east. (the Dan Welsh Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
4.6	2.9	J7: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.) The next 0.4 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
4.8	3.0	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the River & Ruin Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
5.1	3.2	Heads-up: The next 0.4 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
5.5	3.4	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
5.7	3.5	Heads-up: The next 0.4 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
6.1	3.8	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Nature Trails and a Bruce Trail Conservancy trail-change notice.